

Since the content in a blog is determined by the user, there can be blogs on practically any subject under the sun. Blogs are a great way of expressing opinions unhindered by the fear of censorship or unwillingness of publishers. It's free... it's fast... and it's easily accessible! All you need is an account with any of the myriad blogging services which are generally available for free. Customise your blog with templates, widgets, write content and create a community of readers. You can also upload pictures and video. Blogs are a great source of news and have been used effectively by political activists, writers, professionals and the like to get their message across. To know what the world is talking about, you need to be familiar with blogs.

A new fad these days is micro-blogging. This is really catching on as people find that they don't have all day at hand to write those long insightful pieces. Such services allow you to write sentences with not more than 200 words, while answering a standard question like "What are you doing?". If you have used the status feature in Facebook, then you probably know what we are talking about. Here, is a rundown of the most common and popular blogging tools you will ever need.

2.1 Blogging

2.1.1 Blogger (www.blogger.com)

Blogger, is one of the most widely known blog hosting Web sites. It used to be an independent site before being taken over by Google. Therefore, you can use your Google account to create a blog—in a few minutes, complete with all the bells and whistles and the eye candy! Here is how you go about doing that.

Navigate to www.blogger.com and sign in using your Google username and password. You will have to choose a name for your blog. When it comes to hosting, Blogger offers two options—either you can host the blog on the Blogger server, or on a dedicated server. The latter option becomes viable if your blog has garnered plenty of hits and is very popular. Blogs can be posted via FTP or SFTP (Secure FTP). Before doing that, however, you need to set up your blog.